

# Ryan Wilson

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## UX Leader | Product Practice Builder | Hands-On Designer & Front-End Developer

UX and Product leader with nearly 25 years of experience who has built design and product practices from zero, twice: at Callibrity, growing the Product Practice from a single founding hire into a nine-person team; earlier at Bitovi, rebuilding a two-person team into ten while growing UX consulting sales from \$1M to \$2.5M in two years. Still hands-on by choice: builds design systems and component libraries personally, ships accessible and responsive production front ends, and speaks publicly on accessibility. Author of a company-wide AI-enablement standard built on a human-decision-authority principle: AI accelerates the work, people make the decisions. An early adopter of AI-assisted design-to-code workflows. Experienced designing multi-persona, workflow-heavy platforms across enterprise, nonprofit, and community-facing work.

## EXPERIENCE

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### Director of Product, Callibrity | Nov 2023–Present

- Founding individual contributor of Callibrity's Product Practice; grew it into a nine-person team by recruiting and mentoring each hire, while remaining a practicing designer
- Authored and rolled out a company-wide AI-enablement standard grounded in a human-decision-authority principle: AI accelerates production work, people make the decisions
- Built the design system, component library, and production front end for FEG and for CHIRP Radio (nonprofit), applying an AI-assisted design-to-code methodology across both engagements
- Directed a compressed engagement for a confidential funds management firm: a three-person team took a Figma-paired, Storybook-documented component library from design tokens to a full production front end in thirteen weeks
- Led client strategy and delivery for organizations including Honda HALO, FlyWire, GE Aerospace, and Town of Cary
- Built a Product Consultant career ladder tied to impact, growth, and engagement, and rebuilt the quarterly review process around it

### Product Experience Lead, LPL Financial | Jul 2023–Nov 2023

- Collaborated cross-functionally to align on product vision, define strategy, and incorporate user insights into roadmap and prioritization
- Brought human-centered design rigor to financial digital products through iterative testing and accessible design standards

### Principal UX Consultant, SimpleThread | Sep 2022–Jul 2023

- Led product strategy, design, and delivery for healthcare and utility sector clients
- Served as an embedded leader in client teams to bridge design, development, and business needs

### Senior Product Consultant, Kroger | Aug 2021–Sep 2022

- Directed discovery and solution definition, as part of a three-person team, for the software Kroger uses to receive \$28 billion in direct-store-delivery product every year
- Conducted field research and built user flows and prototypes to reduce friction in Direct Store Delivery (DSD) workflows

### Director of User Experience, Bitovi | Jul 2019–Aug 2021

- Took over a two-person design team and rebuilt it deliberately, headcount and infrastructure together, growing it to ten people and UX sales from \$1M to \$2.5M in two years while holding utilization above 90%
- Recruited, mentored, and managed the team; led internal operations and process improvement
- Delivered engagements with Apple, Lowe's, Yum! Brands, and Winklevoss Capital

### Senior User Experience Consultant, Bitovi | May 2016–Jul 2019

- Delivered end-to-end product design for B2B and B2C clients; led workshops, wireframes, usability tests, and Agile ceremonies
- Led UX for a multi-entity Yum! Brands engagement, building a single menu management tool for Pizza Hut, Taco Bell, and KFC, replacing three separate brand-specific systems

Previous Roles: Assistant Professor, Graphic Design (Marshall University); Graphic Design Instructor (Iowa State University); Art Director; Director of Creative Services

## INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

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- **am-ui:** Zero-dependency component library with 44 production components and a live Figma-to-code token bridge with CI-enforced drift detection; built in one week, maintained on an ongoing basis
- **Conference speaker, accessibility:** AHFE (Applied Human Factors and Ergonomics), Nice 2024 and Orlando 2025

## CORE SKILLS

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- Practice Building: recruiting, mentoring, and leveling teams; career-ladder design; scalable process frameworks
- Design Systems & Component Libraries: Figma (components, design tokens, interactive prototypes), am-ui
- AI-Augmented Workflows: authored and rolled out a company-wide AI-enablement standard; AI-assisted design-to-code methodology
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA hands-on validation, accessible pattern design; conference speaker on accessibility
- Front-End Fluency: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, used to build responsive production front ends (desktop, tablet, mobile)
- Research & Synthesis: personas, product flows, workshop facilitation, discovery
- Analytics & Measurement: quantitative and qualitative usability testing data used to drive product decisions; working familiarity with Google Analytics and Hotjar

## EDUCATION

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Ph.D., Human Computer Interaction | Iowa State University, 2015 MFA, Graphic Design | Iowa State University, 2014 MS, Human Computer Interaction | Iowa State University, 2012 BS, Interactive Multimedia | Ohio University, 2001

## PORTFOLIO

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